

Educating people on environmental harm of AI

Posted by u/somerandobitch • • 0 points • 0 comments

Hello, I think many of us are learning about the constitution of AI on the environment such as high energy consumption and freshwater usage. TLDR: how can we educate people on risk of AI and encourage conscious use?

Sometimes I forget that the information I get from my corner of the internet isn't what everyone else is seeing and I want to give people the benefit of the doubt that they might not know about these harms. I work for local government in a small town on sustainability projects, lots related to implementation of our climate action plan.

My boss works on lots of projects related to waste diversion and is passionate about protecting our natural resources. I've heard her and others talk about using AI such as generating graphics for a flyer or helping them write an email (or lots of personal silly stuff). Our community is full of people who spend tons of time outdoors on our river and hiking in our mountains. I struggle with knowing that these people care about nature and the environment but then are using AI in ways that to me are just sort of lazy and unnecessary. Additionally my new roommates texted our group chat about "using our lovely friend chat gtp" to figure out how to pay our trash bill.

I'm looking for advice on how you would go about educating people on the risks of AI and to be conscious when using AI if it's worth the environmental damage. Additionally does anyone know of any businesses or governments with policy's on AI use in workplace? I want to suggest to our IT some type of internal policy since it feels so hypocritical that we have all these energy reduction and water conservation policies and goals in place but then some employees are essentially going against those by using AI in every step of their day.

Comments

u/Muted-Health-3514 • 1 points • 2025-07-10 17:28 UTC

I'm not sure either but going around saying "AI is evaporating our water supply!" didn't work so I'm back to square one..